

An extroverted world

In today's world, there is a general trend toward promoting extrovert values. Schools and workplaces encourage group learning and team tasks. It can be easy for an introverted person to feel uncomfortable or overwhelmed.

Whatever the trend, the important thing to remember—for introvert, extrovert, and ambivert alike—is that everyone thrives and struggles in different scenarios. Accepting this enables people to learn, build, and execute ways to focus on their different strengths in different scenarios.



MYTH BUSTER

The truth about introverts and extroverts

Extroverts aren't necessarily good at public speaking.

Some are, but some aren't. Public speaking is a skill that needs to be learned and practiced. Extroverts may be less nervous, but what they say still needs to be carefully crafted—which is a skill associated with introverts.

Introversion is not the same thing as shyness. Whether someone is introverted or extroverted has no bearing on if they are shy or socially confident.

◀ **Thriving side by side**

While extroverts may shine in a school world that is geared to their ideals, introverts can thrive in their own ways, such as through using those steadfast traits of focus and concentration to block out distractions.

Explaining the science

Some images of extroverts' brains show messages traveling along direct routes when they're being processed. This may help to explain why extroverts enjoy jumping to the next new topic or experience. The longer pathway for introverts may explain why they like to think through things more and take time to process.



△ **Introvert pathway**

An introvert's more complex message route is processed by many parts that deal with memory, planning, and problem-solving.



△ **Extrovert pathway**

An extrovert's message takes a more direct route and is mostly processed by the brain's sensory decoder, which may show why extroverts crave new inputs.

PARENT TIPS

Supporting your teen

Knowing your teen's personality means you can support them whether they are introverted or extroverted.

If they're an introvert:

- give them time to think things through before making decisions.
- respect their private nature, and allow them to be quiet in social situations, as well as at home.
- appreciate their need to work alone, and praise their discipline and focus.

If they're an extrovert:

- let them jump in feet first and find their own way.
- encourage their enthusiasm and allow them to voice their thoughts to think.
- let them multitask, even if it means things take longer.